

Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Scenario 02

Who can see the Copilot Dashboard & its reports — and why two colleagues on the same licence differ

TYPICALLY REPORTED BY

A user whose colleague (same team, similar licence) sees nothing or a permission-denied page — or an admin asking “who is *supposed* to see this, and how do I grant or restrict it?”

SURFACES INVOLVED

`analysis.insights.cloud.microsoft` , M365 Admin Center (VFAM), Entra ID

ROLES TOUCHED

Global Admin, Insights Admin, AI Admin, Insights Analyst, qualified senior leaders, explicitly assigned users, delegates, people-managers

VERSION

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Quick answer

The **Reports** surface shows reports to people who already have a qualifying Copilot Dashboard access source. Administrative roles are independent and non-cumulative: **AI Administrator does not automatically receive a Dashboard view, and Insights Administrator receives neither analyst rights nor automatic viewing.** Entitlement and Viva feature access management (VFAM) remain separate gates that can still block a qualified user.

The access model — exact access sources plus gates

Access source	How it is obtained	Scope	Important boundary

Global Administrator	Role-derived automatic access	Your company	The only administrator role in this scenario that grants company access by role. In a PIM-enabled tenant a Global Administrator might not have Dashboard access and must be added explicitly.
Qualified senior leader	Automatic identification from supported hierarchy and tenant criteria	Eligible hierarchy / company experience	Eligibility and auto-enablement must be active. Microsoft's criteria include a tenant with at least 2,500 users with an Entra ID and most users in a single reporting line; otherwise assign access explicitly.
Explicitly assigned user	Added through Dashboard access management	Assigned company access	Use this for an AI Administrator or Insights Administrator who also needs to view.
Insights Analyst on Global partition	Insights Analyst role plus Global partition assignment	Your company	A non-Global partition does not grant company Dashboard access.
Manager	Manager Settings enabled; valid hierarchy, entitlement, and minimum team size	Your group	Microsoft's sources disagree on manager access to the Agent Dashboard: the Agent Dashboard article says enabled managers see agent insights scoped to their teams, while the Roles in Viva Insights matrix lists no Manager access. Verify in the tenant.

Eligible delegate	An eligible Dashboard user delegates access	The granted scope: Your group, Your company, or Combined access (company plus group, includes the Consumption Dashboard)	No cascading; maximum 75 delegates. Agent Dashboard needs “Your company” or “Combined access” and its separate prerequisites; “Your company” does not include the Consumption Dashboard.
AI Administrator / Insights Administrator only	Administrative role assignment	No view by role	AI Administrator needs explicit access; Insights Administrator also needs Insights Analyst separately to run queries.
Gate: VFAM	Any user or group	Viva Feature Access Management — group-scoped policy on the Viva Insights web app control (turning it off disables the entire web app, including the Copilot Dashboard)	Can override a qualifying source to <i>no access</i> .
Gate: entitlement	Required Viva Insights / Copilot service plan	Necessary, not sufficient	A licence does not grant a Dashboard scope by itself.

The diagnosis reduces to three questions: **Which exact access source grants my scope? Do I have the required entitlement? Is VFAM or current service/rollout state blocking me?**

Sources: Connect to the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard for Microsoft 365 customers (Last updated 29 September 2026), Roles in Viva Insights (Last updated 7 July 2026), Manage settings for the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, Consumption Dashboard, and Viva Insights web app (13 August 2026), Delegate access to the Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, and Copilot insights (Last updated 16 September 2026), and Configure manager settings (Last updated 23 July 2026).

The most likely answer is “working as designed”

Before hunting for a broken setting: if your colleague is an **individual contributor** with no Global Administrator role, qualifying senior-leader status, explicit assignment, Global-partition analyst assignment, manager scope, or delegation, they are correctly seeing nothing. An AI Administrator or Insights Administrator role alone does not change that result.

30-second diagnosis

1. **Should the colleague see it at all?** Check every access source in the matrix. If none applies, **stop: this is working as designed.**
2. **Which source grants *your* access?** Confirm role, explicit assignment, Global partition, senior-leader eligibility, Manager Settings, or delegation. Do not infer viewing from AI Administrator or Insights Administrator.
3. **Colleague is a manager but sees nothing?** Confirm Manager Settings is ON
(`analysis.insights.cloud.microsoft` → **Settings** → **Manager settings** → “Grant managers scoped access to Copilot insights”), their team meets the minimum team size (lowest allowed setting 5; the manager counts), and their `Manager` attribute is populated.
4. **Should qualify but still can’t load the surface?** Check for a **VFAM gate** blocking their group, then confirm their Viva Insights / Copilot licence.

Causes ranked by likelihood

#	Cause	Why it happens	Fix & verification
1	The colleague has no qualifying access source. <i>Working as designed.</i>	An individual contributor with no Global Administrator role, qualified senior-leader status, explicit assignment, Global-partition analyst assignment, manager scope, or delegation has no Dashboard scope. A licence or administrative role alone is not enough.	• Check all access sources in the matrix, including explicit assignment and Global-partition analyst access. • If none applies, close the case as expected behaviour. If access is legitimate, use explicit assignment or delegation rather than an unrelated privileged role.
2	You are a Global Administrator, or you have another company-wide access source; the colleague does not.	Only Global Administrator is role-derived company access here. AI Administrator needs explicit Dashboard assignment. Insights Administrator has no automatic view and no analyst rights; an Insights Analyst receives company access only when assigned to the Global partition.	• Check both users' roles, explicit Dashboard assignments, analyst partitions, senior-leader eligibility, and delegations. • If the colleague needs read-only access, prefer explicit assignment or an eligible company-scoped delegation over a new admin role. • Verify: identify the exact source that produces the "Your company" scope chip.

3

Manager Settings is OFF tenant-wide.

If Manager Settings has never enabled “Grant managers scoped access,” no qualifying manager sees team-level data. A Global Administrator, explicitly assigned user, qualified senior leader, Global-partition analyst, or delegate may still see reports through a different source.

- `analysis.insights.cloud.microsoft` → **Settings** → **Manager settings** → toggle “Grant managers scoped access to Copilot insights” ON (and, optionally, “Grant managers scoped access to Consumption insights”).
- Allow **~1 hour** for the change to propagate.
- **Verify:** after propagation, a qualifying manager sees a “Your group” scope on the dashboard.
- See Admin Setup Guide — Manager Settings step.

4

The colleague’s team is below the minimum team size.

To protect individual privacy, manager-scoped views are suppressed unless the team meets the minimum team size (the lowest allowed setting is 5; the manager counts toward the total). A manager of a small team sees an empty view even when everything else is configured correctly.

- Count the colleague’s direct + indirect reports (including themselves).
- If genuinely small, this is by design — the minimum cannot go below 5.
- Note: **minimum team size** (Manager Settings) is distinct from **minimum group size** (Privacy settings) — see Privacy Configuration Guide.

5

The colleague's `Manager` attribute (or manager hierarchy) isn't populated.

Manager access and automatic senior-leader identification depend on a manager hierarchy — either the Entra ID `Manager` attribute or a `ManagerId` column in uploaded org data. Missing hierarchy means the platform can't establish who reports to whom.

- Check the colleague's Entra profile (`Manager` field) and, if org data is uploaded, the `ManagerId` mapping.
- Populate via HR sync, Entra, or the org-data CSV upload.
- **Verify:** after the next data refresh (~1 hour for settings; longer for a full org-data reprocess), the manager view populates.

6

You received a delegation; the colleague did not.

An eligible Dashboard user can delegate access to specific people (up to 75 delegates; no cascading). If you were delegated access and your colleague wasn't, you see the reports and they don't.

- Ask whether a leader shared access with you. The delegating leader can add the colleague the same way.
- Delegation rules: max 75 delegates, no cascading, scope follows the delegator; access is revoked if the delegator leaves the org.
- See Dashboard Guide — "How to Delegate Access."

A VFAM gate blocks the colleague's web-app or Copilot Dashboard access.

Viva Feature Access Management can turn off the **Viva Insights web app** control (which disables the entire web app, including the Copilot Dashboard) for specific groups regardless of their access source. If the colleague is in a group covered by a restrictive policy, the surface does not load. This may be deliberate; see “Deliberately restricting access” below.

- `admin.microsoft.com` → Viva → **Feature Access Management** → Viva Insights → verify the **Viva Insights web app** control is ON for the colleague's group (earlier Copilot Dashboard VFAM or PowerShell configurations now apply to the entire web app), and that the separate **Agent Dashboard** control is ON if they need it.
- Remember VFAM policies are group-scoped — confirm which policy applies, and whether the block is intentional before lifting it.
- **Verify:** after the policy change, the colleague can load `analysis.insights.cloud.microsoft`.

The colleague lacks the required Viva Insights / Copilot entitlement.

Even with the right role or manager hierarchy, the web-app surface requires the appropriate licence assignment. An unlicensed (or differently licensed) colleague is blocked at the door.

- `admin.microsoft.com` → Users → Active Users → select the colleague → *Licenses and apps* → confirm the Viva Insights / Copilot entitlement.
- **Verify:** the licence shows assigned and active.

Recent change hasn't propagated yet.

Role assignments refresh on next sign-in (up to ~60 min if a session stays open); Manager Settings changes take ~1 hour; org-data hierarchy changes can take longer to reprocess.

- Have the colleague sign out of all M365 surfaces and back in (incognito is fastest).
- Wait the full propagation window before escalating.
- **Verify:** re-check the Microsoft Entra admin center → *Roles and administrators* → *Your Role* and the dashboard scope chip.

Most common misdiagnosis

This is usually escalated as “the same licence behaves differently for two people — it must be a bug.” In practice the users differ on an access source, hierarchy, assignment, partition, delegation, or gate. Identical licences do *not* imply identical Dashboard access — entitlement is necessary but never sufficient.

Surface vs. scope — keep these separate

Two different questions are easy to conflate:

- **Does the dashboard / Reports surface appear at all?** → governed by an exact access source from the matrix, entitlement, VFAM, and current service/rollout state.
- **Does a *manager* see *team-level* data within it?** → governed by Manager Settings + manager hierarchy + minimum team size.

Diagnose which question you're actually answering before chasing a fix.

Worked example — the executive sponsor who isn't a manager

This case comes up constantly, so it's worth walking through end-to-end because the intuitive answer is the *wrong* one.

The situation

The **executive sponsor** of the organisation's Copilot rollout needs the org-wide **adoption report** to track the programme. The sponsor is *not* a people-manager — with no direct reports — and holds no admin role. The instinctive move is “they're an exec, just give them *manager* access.” That doesn't work, and it's worth understanding why.

Why “manager” is the wrong lever. In Viva Insights, “*manager*” is not a statement about seniority or importance — it is a literal test of whether the person has **direct or indirect reports**, established by the `PersonId` / `ManagerId` hierarchy. You cannot enable someone as a manager who has nobody reporting to them, no matter how senior they are. And even if the sponsor *did* have a small team, manager access would only show **that team's** adoption — not the **company-wide** view an executive sponsor actually needs.

The correct lever here is delegation. The sponsor could receive company access through explicit assignment, qualifying senior-leader identification, Global-partition analyst assignment, Global Administrator, or an eligible company-scoped delegation. For a read-only sponsor who does not otherwise qualify, delegation is the least-privilege choice; do not assign an administrative or analyst role merely to create a view.

Step	Action
1	Identify a delegator who already has company-level access — a senior leader with automatic access, or a Global Administrator.
2	That leader opens the Viva Insights web app → Settings → Delegation → Add delegates , adds the sponsor, and assigns the scope “ Your company. ” (Combined access also includes the Consumption Dashboard; see the delegation caveats below.)
3	Confirm the sponsor holds the required Viva Insights / Copilot entitlement , which is necessary but not sufficient.
4	Check no VFAM gate blocks the sponsor's group from the Viva Insights web app / Copilot Dashboard.

The sponsor opens the Viva Insights web app → **Reports** and sees the org-wide adoption report under the delegating leader's view.

Delegation caveats to set expectations

- A delegate sees the surface *as the delegating leader* — a banner shows whose insights they're viewing.
- Delegation is capped at **75 delegates** per leader and **cannot cascade** (the sponsor can't re-delegate).
- If the delegating leader loses their own access (e.g. leaves the org), **the sponsor's access is revoked too** — so prefer a stable senior leader or a Global Admin as the delegator.
- If the delegator has both company-level and group access, existing "Your company" delegates automatically become **Combined access** and might see the Consumption Dashboard. Review delegate scopes after this change.
- Microsoft's articles disagree on Consumption Dashboard delegation. How to use the Consumption Dashboard says access can't currently be delegated, while Delegate access describes a Combined access delegate scope that includes it. Test in the tenant before relying on either, and review existing delegates' scopes.

This matches Microsoft Learn exactly: the Copilot Analytics reports prerequisites list automatic access, *delegate* access, Insights Analyst, or Global Admin — with no "promote a non-manager to manager" path — and the delegate-access guidance confirms a company-scoped delegation is how a non-manager gets the org-wide view.

Deliberately restricting access (the inverse problem)

The harder, higher-stakes version of this question is the reverse: “How do I make sure a particular leader or group *cannot* see the dashboard, even though their role or hierarchy would normally grant it?” This is the everyday reality in regulated, multi-agency, or shared-tenant deployments where one agency’s leaders must not see another’s data.

Some access sources are automatic, including qualified senior-leader and enabled manager access. The **VFAM gate is the supported surface-control lever for removing access**:

Goal	How	Watch out for
Block a specific set of users from the dashboard	Create a group-scoped VFAM policy that turns the Viva Insights web app feature OFF for an Entra group (e.g. <code>AgencyUsers-NoDashboard</code>), then set the separate Agent Dashboard control explicitly. The former Copilot Dashboard control and its <code>-FeatureId CopilotDashboard</code> policy are no longer available — see Multi-Agency Setup, Phase 1.	Disabling the web-app control removes the Copilot Dashboard, Copilot Analytics reports, and advanced analysis and admin tools together — there is no documented way to remove only the dashboard. Scope the policy to the <i>group</i> , never to “Everyone” — an Everyone-level block also strips access from non-agency executives who legitimately need it. Any negative test recorded against the old control is no longer evidence ; re-run it against the current control.
Let agency managers see <i>only</i> their own agency	Combine the VFAM block above with partition-scoped analyst queries (the Restricted Reporting pattern) so that, where analyst access <i>is</i> granted, queries are scoped to the agency.	VFAM controls the <i>surface</i> ; partitions scope <i>analyst queries</i> . You usually need both for agency-scoped reporting.
Confirm a block actually took effect	Have a test user in the blocked group sign out / in and load <code>analysis.insights.cloud.microsoft</code> .	VFAM changes are not instant — allow propagation time before concluding it didn’t work.

Microsoft’s feature access management article states that its access controls aren’t available in GCC High or DoD. For GCC, check the documentation for the specific app. Delegation can be turned off separately with the **Viva Insights Web App Delegation** control, and delegates must also be permitted to use the dashboard.

Use group-scoped policies, never “Everyone”

The most common multi-agency mistake is blocking the Copilot Dashboard at the “Everyone” level to lock down agency users — which also blocks senior executives and central admins who are supposed to see tenant-wide adoption. Always target a dedicated Entra group (e.g. `AgencyUsers-NoDashboard`). See the Restricted Reporting Pattern for the full group-scoped lockdown pattern.

What “done” looks like

- You can name the exact source that grants **your** access and scope, plus the required entitlement and absence of a VFAM block.
- You’ve confirmed the colleague either has no qualifying source — in which case it’s **correct by design** — or you’ve found the missing item: explicit access, Global partition, eligible hierarchy, Manager Settings, delegation, entitlement, or VFAM.
- If the goal was the *inverse* — restricting access — the right users are blocked via a **group-scoped** VFAM policy (never “Everyone”), verified by a test user in the blocked group.

Related

- [Troubleshooting Scenarios catalogue](#) — browse all scenarios.
 - [Troubleshooting Guide](#) — symptom-tables for single-surface lookups.
 - [Dashboard Guide](#) — access scopes, delegation, and the Reports surface.
 - [Admin Setup Guide](#) — role assignment and Manager Settings step.
 - [Privacy Configuration Guide](#) — minimum team size vs. minimum group size.
 - [Restricted Reporting Pattern](#) — group-scoped VFAM lockdown and partition-scoped analyst queries.
 - [FAQ](#) — common access questions.
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